

Ask Noor

Her voice, in every language



HACKNATION WORLD BANK YOUTH SUMMIT: TOURISM CHALLENGE

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ON NOOR'S FARM, A GUEST ASKS

“Kan ik wat bonen mee naar huis nemen?”

Dutch for “Can I take some beans home?”

Noor doesn't speak Dutch. The guide is busy. The question is lost, and so is a sale.



Noor's fictional, however her week isn't.

Her constraints come from World Bank work with tourism and small operators in The Gambia.

6 to 7 visitors a month

All by word of mouth. No listing. A local guide translates for them.

Her own language

She uses the national language only when she has to.

Weekend smartphone

Her daughter boards at school and helps her use it on weekends.

No Wi-Fi

The family buys 3G bundles only when they need them.



The Gap In Data

20.4%

of The Gambia's GDP came from tourism in 2019, counting indirect effects. Also 17.3% of jobs.

2.6×

growth in arrivals from 2010 to 2019: 91,000 to 235,800 visitors a year.

35%

of full-time tourism jobs in The Gambia are held by women, against 54% globally.

22%

smartphone gender gap in Sub-Saharan Africa in 2025: women are that much less likely to own one.

Tourism clusters on the coast. Hosts like Noor sell by word of mouth, and lose every guest's feedback when the guide goes home.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Because of Ask Noor, Noor will learn what her foreign guests asked, loved and ordered, by SMS in her own language each weekend, and answer them in her **own voice** before the next tour, instead of losing that feedback when they leave; we know because her guests reach her only through a translating guide, and in The Gambia, where tourism drives **20.4% of GDP, women hold just 35% of full-time tourism jobs.**



HOW IT WORKS

Guests ask, Noor answers.

NOOR'S WEEKEND

1 · Record

With her daughter, Noor records her farm's stories in her own language on the family smartphone.



VISITOR AT HOTEL

2 · Download

The visitor saves a small tour pack on their own phone. On the farm it plays Noor's voice with subtitles, no signal needed.



VISITOR ON FARM

3 · Ask & order

They ask in their language and hear Noor's matching clip, or "not sure, ask your guide." They can tap "I'd like this" on her beans.



NOOR'S FRIDAY

4 · Learn

One SMS in her language: "7 guests, 5 bean orders, 3 asked about staying overnight."

Guests leave with Noor's recipe and a farm card to send a friend. That weekend, Noor records answers to the top questions.



DEMO filmed in airplane mode

Finn's visit.

One Dutch guest. A question Noor has answered, one she hasn't yet.

1 · Save the tour

2 · Hear Noor

3 · Ask in Hindi

4 · Order beans, pay cash

5 · "Not sure, ask your guide"

6 · Recipe + farm card

7 · Noor's Friday report

8 · Next guest hears her answer



Why not something simpler?

The tour itself is simple on purpose. The AI lives in the moment a guest asks something, and in what Noor learns afterwards.

Doesn't work

SMS

Noor can't read Dutch, and Femke needs the answer now, not next week.

Doesn't work

A spreadsheet FAQ

It looks up exact words.
"Bonen mee naar huis" never matches "buy coffee".

Doesn't work

Google search

It knows nothing about Noor's farm, and needs a signal the farm doesn't have.

✓ WORKS

Ask Noor

Matches meaning across languages, offline, and plays Noor's own answer, or says "not sure" and saves it for her.



GUARDRAILS

What Finn sees

Noor hasn't answered this yet. Please ask your guide. With your OK, we'll save your question for her.

What Noor gets on Friday

[Wolof SMS] "1 guest asked about: staying overnight."



A fixed list of answers

It only shows what Noor recorded or approved: clips, prices, facts with a source.



A confidence threshold

Below it, the guest sees "ask your guide", never a guess.



People check every translation

Back-translation flags drift; a fluent speaker approves subtitles; Noor approves what goes live.



Consent and minimal data

Guests opt in. No names or numbers stored. Questions deleted after the digest.



No voice cloning

Noor's voice is never made to say something she didn't say.



Payment stays in person

Guests pay Noor directly. The app never handles money or card details.



One visit: a sale, a referral, and a new idea



A sale: product cards

Roasted beans, ground coffee, a recipe kit, at prices Noor sets. A tap on "I'd like this" shows the order in her language; the guest pays her in person, in cash.



A referral: recipe and farm card

Guests keep Noor's coffee recipe and a card to send a friend. Any text it sends is prewritten in her language.



A new idea: what guests ask for

Questions Noor hasn't answered show demand she couldn't see before, like guests wanting to stay overnight.

Noor's basic phone · Friday

This month:

7 guests

5 bean orders

3 asked: stay overnight

Loved: the roasting

Shown in English for you; Noor
reads it in Wolof.



WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Any host with a story and a basic phone.

More hosts

Farm stays, craft workshops, fishing trips.
Record clips, print QR cards. We do not want to restrain this.

More languages

A new guest language is one more translation pass. A new host language needs a fluent speaker in the loop.

Other sectors

A clinic's answers to common questions; a co-op's price FAQs. This fixed answer can be useful in a clinic and the corporate world.

Next 90 Days: Pilot with one host and a fluent speaker, add spoken questions and a share card that turns happy guests into referrals

It isn't teaching a chatbot to speak Wolof. It's keeping the local person as the author, and building AI that admits what it doesn't know, in her language.



Thank you!





Sources

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